

Open Meeting Law complaint: Lunenburg School Committee minutes

Statement attached to the Open Meeting Law Complaint Form.

Date of alleged violation: ongoing; most recently 1 October 2026.

Description of the alleged violation

The School Committee is not making the minutes of its meetings available, as M.G.L. c.30A, §22(c) requires.

The most recent minutes the Committee has made available are dated 24 June 2026. Since that date the Committee has announced and posted agendas for eight meetings — 15 and 29 July, 26 August, 2, 9, 16 and 25 September and 1 October 2026 — and no minutes for any of them are available. Section 22(c) requires minutes to be approved "in a timely manner" and to be public records. If these minutes have been approved, they have not been made available; if they have not been approved, three months is not timely.

This is not a recent lapse. Counting only meetings the Town itself announced on its AgendaCenter, against the minutes posted there for the same body, and counting each meeting date once even where the agenda was posted more than once:

calendar year	meetings announced	minutes available	not available
2022	25	0	25
2023	43	9	34
2024	36	27	9
2025	46	30	16
2026 (to 1 Oct)	27	14	13

Every figure above was read from the Town's own AgendaCenter on 5 October 2026. I am not inferring that these meetings occurred — the Committee published a notice for each one.

I also requested these records directly. On 8 September 2026 I emailed the Chair asking for copies of the minutes of 35 meetings, each identified by date and by the Town's own agenda URL. On 9 September she replied that a staff member was looking into it. On 17 September she wrote that she believed most of those minutes had been approved but not posted, and that staff needed to verify which had been approved, which was delayed because the central office is without a finance director. I replied that I would accept them in any form, without their being posted. As of 5 October 2026 none of the 35 has been provided or posted. Section 22(c) requires minutes to be available on request.

The minutes are the only record of what was decided for a resident who cannot attend or watch a three-hour meeting, and for most of the meetings listed above no written record has been made available.

The remedy I am seeking

1. Provide the minutes already approved, and identify those not yet approved, with a schedule for approving them.
2. Where a listed meeting was cancelled or has no minutes, say so against that date.
3. Bring the minutes current and keep them within a stated interval going forward.
4. Post the minutes beside the agendas on the AgendaCenter.

I am not seeking to invalidate any action the Committee has taken.

TJ Loughlin

[contact details as on the filed form -- kept out of this public repository]